

IST 263 Project Milestone 2 – Copy Document

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Description (From Milestone 1):

Please paste your project description from Project Milestone 1 here. If you've changed your mind about the topic of your project, feel free to rewrite your description.

My idea for my website displays the types of piercing placements someone can get on their body. I have around 15 piercings total, which have varied in pain tolerance, and I want to create this site to help people understand their bodies as well as making sure they purchase the right type of jewelry. This site is meant to share my tips on healing the more untraditional piercings and provides information on what I wish someone would've shared with me on my journey.

Home Page

Short Description

This page introduces the site, the mission as well as give a brief history on the history of piercings since I have done previous research on this topic.

Actual Page Text

Throughout history, the act of piercings has been practiced for thousands of years across many cultures as forms of self-expression, spirituality, and social identity. Archaeological evidence shows ear piercings in ancient civilizations such as Egypt, where jewelry symbolized wealth and status, and in South Asia, where piercings were connected to religious and cultural traditions. Indigenous cultures across Africa and America also used body piercings to mark rites of passage, beauty standards, or community belonging. In modern times, piercings have shifted from traditional and ritual meanings to mainstream fashion and personal expression, reflecting changing social norms and individual identity.

Just over the past decade, body modifications and piercings have risen in popularity, which makes it important to consider what types are available, how to find a reputable piercer, what

jewelry is right for your body, and most importantly, how to care for your new piercing! The process can be daunting for new customers, but it doesn't have to be. Caring for your new piercing means looking to care for your body in a new way, and it takes commitment.

PIERCING TYPES

- Lobe
 - Cartilage
 - Conch
 - Daith
 - Rook
 - Nose
 - Lip
 - Naval
-

Page 2

Title: Piercing Basics

Short Description

This page describes the first rules of obtaining a piercing including where to get one, jewelry types, and responsibilities of caring for a piercing.

Actual Page Text

FINDING A REPUTABLE PIERCER

Getting a piercing on your own opens a variety of ways to obtain one. Sure, you may have walked past a Claire's or investigated a shiny jewelry stand in the mall that offers a piercing service usually done with a piercing gun. However, this is one of the most dangerous and least recommended methods by reputable piercers, as it is easy to damage cartilage and is more

painful. A reputable piercer is someone who has obtained a Bloodborne Pathogens Certification (BPP), a body piercing license, and has trained through an apprenticeship. These standards ensure that your piercer uses a sterilized needle and keeps you safe in the piercing process.

JEWELRY TYPES

Reputable piercing shops typically offer jewelry made from implant-grade titanium, implant-grade stainless steel, and solid gold. Implant-grade titanium is considered the safest option because it is lightweight, corrosion-resistant, and truly hypoallergenic, making it ideal for initial piercings. Implant-grade stainless steel is widely used and safe for many people, but it may contain trace amounts of nickel, which can cause irritation in individuals with metal sensitivities. Solid gold jewelry (14k–18k) is also safe for piercings when it is nickel-free and not gold-plated. Our bodies don't always react to metals the same way, and it is possible to be allergic to metals. I learned the hard way after many years of attempting to heal my piercings with gold jewelry, only later finding out through a patch test, that I was allergic! My advice would be to spend your money on high quality jewelry, starting off with surgical steel or titanium

RESPONSIBILITIES

Piercing aftercare remains relatively consistent across all earring types, beginning with cleaning the piercing 1–2 times daily using a sterile saline solution and gauze to gently remove buildup and reduce the risk of infection. A highly recommended brand is NeilMed's Piercing Aftercare Fine Mist solution. Before spraying, always wash your hands before touching the area, and avoid twisting or rotating the jewelry too much, as excess movement can delay healing. It's also best not to sleep on the piercing and keep hair, masks, and earbuds away from the area when possible. Proper aftercare and patience are essential, as even piercings that appear healed on the outside may still be healing internally.

Short Description: The final page will contain all the information about the placements of the jewelry as well as other important information for specific piercings.

Actual Page Text

DIFFERENT TYPES OF PIERCINGS

There are so many different types of piercings you can get, with some being more anatomy dependent than others. It's important to check with your piercer if you have any questions about a piercing and if it is right for you.

LOBE

Lobe piercings are the most common type of piercing, and most people start out with these since they are very low in pain and easy to heal! You can get both lobes pierced at once, and by following traditional aftercare, they only take around 3-4 months to heal. What most people don't know is that lobes don't have to only be placed in the form of "seconds" or "thirds" but stacked as well, as seen in this photo. This could be a great idea for your next ear curation!

NOTE: All piercings after the lobe require the "downsizing" of a post. When jewelry is initially inserted, the length of the bar, or the "post" is usually 1-2 millimeters longer to accommodate swelling and must be downsized around 6-8 weeks after the initial piercing, or whenever swelling has visibly reduced. If downsized too early, the jewelry can become irritating since there is no room for swelling. On the other hand, if it is too late to downsize, the extra length of the post can cause snagging, small irritation bumps, as well as slower healing.

CARTILAGE

Cartilage piercings are pierced on the harder, fleshy part of the ear. The most common placements are the "Helix" that sits on the upper part of the ear, or the "Tragus", which is that small fleshy bit just in front of the ear canal. Most people get their helix done after their lobes but

take around 9-12 months to heal. On the other hand, the tragus heals in 6-9 months. Once the helix and tragus are healed, a popular style is to put a small hoop in.

CONCH

The conch is exactly what it sounds like, it sits in the middle of the ear, in an area that resembles a conch shell! This piercing receives mixed reviews in pain tolerance, with some customers reporting longer healing times than others. Since it sits comfortably in the center of the ear, it is less prone to snagging on clothes or hair. The one downside is that you are unable to use air pods during the healing time of at least one year, as it may put extra pressure and discomfort on the piercing.

DAITH

Daith piercings sit in the inner cartilage of the ear and are the only ear piercing that can initially be fitted with a hoop! Some customers report a small “crunch” sensation during the piercing and experience mild to moderate pain. Healing typically takes about 9–12 months, as it is a cartilage piercing. Although not clinically proven, some people report that daith piercings help reduce the frequency or severity of migraines.

ROOK

Rook piercings sit on the small shelf of the upper inner part of the ear and must be pierced with a curved barbell. Personally, this had been one of my most painful piercings with a slight burn but had an easy healing process as it is located inside the ear. Once the healing of 9-12 months is complete, some change the jewelry into a hoop.

NOSE

Nose piercings are placed on the nostril or septum and are popular for their versatility and subtle appearance. Nostril piercings typically heal faster than cartilage piercings, with an average

healing time of 2–4 months, while septum piercings may heal slightly faster. Initial jewelry is usually a stud or ring made from implant-grade materials. Proper aftercare is important, especially avoiding excessive touching or twisting, as the nose is exposed to bacteria from frequent contact of other germs.

LIP

Lip piercings, such as labret or vertical labret piercings, pass through both skin and lip tissue, which can affect healing. Initial healing generally takes 6–8 weeks, with full healing around 3–4 months. Oral hygiene is especially important, and wearers should avoid playing with the jewelry to prevent tooth and gum damage. Gum recession is quite common for labret piercings, although some customers report that some piercers can specially pierce the skin in a way that does not put too much damage on the gums or teeth. The jewelry starts off with a straight barbell and can then be upgraded to a hoop after a full healing process.

NAVAL

Naval piercings are placed through the rim of the belly button and are anatomy-dependent, meaning not everyone is suited for one. Healing can be slow due to movement and friction from clothing, as well as the movement of sitting down which can squeeze the bellybutton. Full healing takes around 6–12 months, with most people receiving one in the winter, since heat in the summer can irritate the healing process. Curved barbells made from implant-grade materials are standard starter jewelry and should not have any dangling jewelry off the barbell initially. Wearing loose clothing and proper cleaning can help reduce irritation during the healing process.
